Reading comprehension exercise

You are going to read part of an article about the Internet. For questions 1-6, choose the answer (A, B, C or D) which. you think fits best according to the text.

Has the Internet brought us together or driven us apart?

In recent years, the Internet has totally transformed the world. But as we welcome this new-found connectedness, asks Johann Hari, are we losing our culture?

The Internet has changed the way we think about ourselves - the groups we belong to, the information we know, even the people we date. The story of this century so far is the story of the World Wide Web.

It has transformed the way we interact with our friends. When I sent my first email, I was at university, and my main way of contacting my friends if their phone was off was to leave a written note - on a piece of paper! - on their door. When I told this to my 10-year-old nephew, he was astonished, as if I was describing how we had to hunt our own food and then cook it on an open fire built from damp branches.

The web also contains a huge amount of information, but there's a catch. We expect this information to be free - no matter what it costs to produce. This has virtually destroyed the newspaper and record industries, whose products are available online across the world for free. This is obviously good news for the consumer in the short term - but only while enough other people pick up the bill by buying the print copies and CDs. As their numbers decline, there will be a hole left. We will never know all the news stories that won't get written, or the songs that will never be recorded - and there will be many.

In the time I have been writing this article, I have received 36 emails, four texts, two phone calls, and seven instant messenger chat requests. We live in a state of 'permanent partial attention', where we are attempting to focus simultaneously on a whole range of things. But as human beings, we're not very good at it*.

We evolved to focus on one big task at a time. We can adjust to a degree: if you look at brain images of *'digital natives'* - kids who were born in the Internet age - they look different to us *'digital migrants'*, who came to it as adults. They can focus on more varied distractions far longer. But we can only adjust so far.

There's another strange aspect to Internet communication: our manners haven't caught up. I find it much easier to get into arguments with people online than I ever would on the phone, or in person. It's partly because you can't hear their tone of voice: you can read unfriendliness where there is none. We write emails as casually as we make a phone call - but we read them with the seriousness with which we take a letter. Something written in a casual second can be reread and reread far hours.

As I was trying to think through all the complexities of the Internet, I had a thought. What if we logged on tomorrow and the Internet had vanished? Would we be relieved to be suddenly freed from the endless arrival of emails and updates? Would we find our concentration spans mysteriously widening again? Would we see the newspaper and record industries rise again, as people had to pay for their goods once more? Maybe. But I suspect we would feel oddly alone if the great global conversation with 3.2 billion other people - the conversation that has defined this century so far - went dead.

1) The writer mentions talking to his nephew to show how much… 1

A- we have changed the way we do household tasks.
B- the Internet has changed human communication.
C- mobile phones have changed in the last ten years.
D- the importance of friendship has changed.

2) What is the writer's attitude to free online news and music? 2

A- The public will always continue to benefit from access to it.
B- It will mean higher prices for people who still I buy newspapers and records.
C- It will eventually reduce the amount of both reporting and composing.
D- The only losers from it will be media organisations and record companies.

3) What does 'it' refer to? 3

A- concentrating on different matters at the same time.
B- behaving in the way a human being is expected to.
C- giving all our attention to one subject for a short time.
D- communicating with people in different ways.

4) The writer uses the expression 'digital migrants' to mean people who… 4

A- came from countries where Internet use was less common.
B- can adapt more easily to the nature of Internet communications.
C- think that children who use the Internet are not like them.
D- never had the opportunity in their childhood to go online.

5) Why, according to the writer, can an email anger people so easily? 5

A- The reader takes less care reading it than the writer has writing it.
B- People who send emails are often less polite than letter-writers.
C- It is more likely than a letter or phone call to be unfriendly.
D- The reader assumes the writer has given a lot of thought to it.

6) What point is the writer making in the final paragraph? 6

A- People are starting to wish the Internet had never been invented.
B- It is now impossible to undo any of the harm the Internet has caused.
C- People need the communication with others that the Internet provides.
D- One day we will have to learn to live in a world that has no Internet.

Listening comprehension exercise

You will hear a journalist reporting on a prize for young scientists and engineers. For questions 1-10, complete the sentences.

Last year's winners of the National Science & Engineering Competition were both aged 1/

The competition was first held in the year 2/

The bicycle at the Big Bang Fair was used to produce 3/

The main aim of the Fair is to create interest in 4/ in certain branches of science and engineering.

About 5/ of the people attending the Fair were young.

A total of 6/ people took part in the competition.

0ne project involved using a fuel extracted from 7/ to run a motor vehicle.

In the final of the competition, the judges listen to a fairly detailed 8/ of each entry.

The judges assess the 9/ of the team or individual, as well as their project.

The date of the announcement of this year's winners is 10/

Gapped text with multiple choice

For questions 1-9, read the text below and decide which answer (A, B, C or D) best fits each gap.

What on Earth would we do without satellites?

Since the first satellites were (1) _____ by rocket over 50 years ago, the number of communications satellites in space has increased enormously.
As part of (2) _____ positioning systems they tell us where we are on the planet, and can help save lives by, for instance, directing the emergency (3) _____ to the scene of an accident.
Satellites are essential for accurate weather forecasting, and also for space (4) _____ Because they are above the Earth's atmosphere, right on the edge of (5) _____ space, telescopes on satellites can see distant objects up to ten (6) _____ more clearly than they could from the surface of the Earth.
We rely, too, on satellites to make (7) _____ phone calls, and in some remote regions they make it possible for us to (8) _____ the Internet. And, of course, many people watch TV programmes (9) _____ from the other side of the world thanks to satellites, which enable us to watch hundreds of channels in a whole variety of languages.

1	A fired	B- launched	C- flown	D- lifted
2	A global	B- universal	C- regional	D- external
3	A brigades	B- services	C- agencies	D- departments
4	A exploration	B- appreciation	C- examination	D- investigation
5	A outer	B- further	C- broader	D- fainter
6	A points	B- times	C- items	D- numbers
7	A long-running	B- long-range	C- long-term	D- long-distance
8	A connect	B- link	C- access	D- log
9	A published	B- browsed	C- displayed	D- broadcast

Writing – article

(see also booklet 2)

You see this announcement in an international magazine.

What is the most important piece of technology you have?
Write us an article about it, saying why it is so important to you and how it could be improved.

Write your article in 140-190 words.

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Some useful language: reason and result links

Complete the text with these words:

account	because	consequently	owing	reason	result
since	therefore	view	why		

1. As a _____ of the extra tax, the price of electronic goods went up.
2. Ice occupies more space than water, and that is _____ frozen pipes burst.
3. It would take years to reach even the nearest stars, _____ to their huge distance from Earth.
4. Some programs may be running slowly on _____ of a bug in the computer.
5. Metal is heavier than water. _____, if a ship fills with sea water it sinks.
6. Laptops are becoming very popular, and the _____ is that you can take them anywhere.
7. _____ the tunnel is so far underground, mobile phones don't work.
8. In _____ of the fact that hot air is lighter than cold air, a hot-air balloon rises from the ground.
9. Sales of cameras are falling _____ of the increasing use of phones to take photos.
10. Copper is a lot cheaper than gold and _____ it is widely used for carrying electricity.

Writing · article: your answer (140-190 words)

What is the most important piece of technology you have?

Title:

Grammar Reference

PASSIVE FORMS

The passive uses a form of the verb (1) _____ followed by the (2) _____

Rewrite these sentences in the passive. Then match them with uses of the passive (a-e).

	use (a-e)
1. Someone has broken the equipment.	
2. Firstly, you heat up the liquid.	
3. You must wear safety glasses in the laboratory.	
4. A very young student won this year's Science Competition.	
5. People say that Dr Liu is a brilliant scientist.	

a- describing a process
b- when we don't know who did something
c- what people in general believe, expect, etc.
d- polite rules and requests
e- if the object is more important than the subject

Correct the mistakes:

1. Electric light has invented in the 19th century, I think.
2. The final decision is be made right now.
3. You will be ask some questions by the panel of judges.
4. The museum was closed because it was being painting.
5. It is thought that cycling improves your health.
6. When I was a student at school, I used to be teaching science every day.
7. Democracy had born in my country many years before then.
8. Their hearing is said to have worsened considerably.

Replace the underlined active verbs with passive forms. Use *by* only where necessary.

When (1) you warm a meal up in a microwave oven, (2) the food absorbs radio waves and these are converted into heat. While (3) it is cooking the meal, only the food gets hot. So when (4) it has heated the food up, the dish, glass or plastic container will still be relatively cool, as (5) these materials will not have absorbed the radio waves. This means that (6) we can describe microwaving as quite an efficient use of electricity. Although (7) we often think of the microwave as a fairly modern appliance, in fact (8) someone invented it back in 1945. The first microwaves were huge, nearly two metres high, but (9) restaurants were already using them in the 1950s. Within twenty years manufacturers were producing much smaller models, and by 1975 (10) they had sold over a million in the USA alone.

1-
2-
3-
4-
5-
6-
7-
8-
9-
10-

Use passive verbs to complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first sentence. There's no need to use by.

We hope there will be an update soon.
It

Scientists believe there is water on that distant planet.
It .

The public know those chemicals are dangerous.
Those chemicals

We think researchers have made a breakthrough.
Researchers .

Nowadays, people consider it essential to have a mobile phone.
Nowadays, it

There are reports that doctors have found a cure.
It

Collocations

Match the verbs in box A with the nouns in box B to form collocations.

A

attach-	browse-	carry out-	charge-	prove-	run-	store-	undo

B

1. a change (you have made)	
2. data (on a hard disk)	
3. an experiment	
4. a file (to an email)	
5. a mobile phone	
6. a program	
7. a theory	
8. websites	

Choose the correct word (A, B, C or D).

1) Zena's voice was very _____ over the phone. I could hardly hear her.
A- faint B- pale C- dull D- faded

2) Close any _____ like word processing before shutting down your computer.
A- bookmarks B- hardware C- networks D- applications

3) It's easy to _____ the text on the screen, and then edit it.
A- display B- extend C- present D- spread

4) My PC _____ and wouldn't start up at all.
A- collapsed B- crashed C- scratched D- folded

5) Thirteen _____ seventeen is two hundred and twenty-one, I think.
A- plus B- for C- times D- from

6) The accident was caused by a _____ of poor maintenance and human error.
A- connection B- composition C- combination D- conjunction

7) I've got a computer _____, so I'm going to run the anti-virus software.
A- insect B- worm C- pest D- bug